
DIPLOMATIC WORKING PAPER — REVISED EDITION

Pathways to Stability

A First-Phase Reciprocal Framework for Nuclear De-escalation

Version 2.0 — 16 May 2026

Status: Draft for Discussion — Not a Binding Instrument

Scope: First-phase stabilisation only — not a comprehensive settlement

This document integrates technical and political innovations from six independent diplomatic frameworks with current negotiation dynamics as of 16 May 2026. It is offered as a structured tool for negotiators, not as the position of any government.

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1. Executive Summary

Three Core Claims

1. **Neither side moves first.** Every step is paired and simultaneous. Both parties act within the same 72-hour window.
2. **Nothing here is permanent.** The first phase lasts 90 days and renews only by mutual consent. Every obligation can be paused without collapse.
3. **Nothing here is surrender.** Iran keeps sovereign title to its material. The United States keeps all military options. Both sides keep their core demands for any future comprehensive agreement.

Three Benefits

1. **For the US:** Weapons-grade uranium leaves Iranian territory on Day 1, verified by the IAEA. Enrichment above 3.67% stops. New sanctions are not needed.
2. **For Iran:** Frozen assets begin flowing on Day 1. The naval blockade eases. The United States formally acknowledges Iran's right to peaceful nuclear energy.
3. **For both:** Gasoline prices stabilise. The ceasefire solidifies. Diplomats gain time to negotiate a comprehensive deal without the shadow of renewed strikes.

Three Implementation Steps

1. **Days 1-3:** Both parties activate simultaneously. Iran places its 60% HEU stockpile under IAEA seal for transfer to Oman. The US releases \$250 million and eases the naval posture.
2. **Days 4-14:** Three independent verifiers confirm what happened. If all clear, the first economic tranche unlocks. If not, the parties talk.
3. **Days 15-90:** A second, larger asset tranche releases in stages as the IAEA confirms the enrichment cap holds. Both sides negotiate whether to extend, deepen, or conclude.

This is not a comprehensive peace treaty. It is a 90-day reciprocal stabilisation instrument. It resolves one urgent problem: highly enriched uranium is on Iranian soil while military escalation remains a live option. The framework converts that problem into

a verified custodial arrangement, pairs it with immediate, visible economic relief, and creates political space for a broader negotiation.

2. Why Each Side Can Say Yes

Negotiations fail when each side fears the other will exploit its concessions. This framework addresses that fear directly. Here is the honest case for each side.

2.1 What the United States Gets

Visible Security Win on Day 1

The entire stockpile of 60% enriched uranium — the material closest to weapons-grade — leaves Iranian territory and enters IAEA custody in Oman. Not in two years. Not after a long negotiation. On Day 1. IAEA inspectors verify the transfer in real time. The President can announce this as a direct security achievement.

A Binding Enrichment Cap, Verified Daily

Iran commits to stop enrichment above 3.67%. IAEA inspectors verify this on Iranian soil every day. If Iran breaks the cap, the asset releases pause automatically. The United States does not need to negotiate a response — the mechanism is built in. But the United States retains full discretion to reimpose sanctions through its own channels at any time, for any reason unrelated to this framework.

No New Concessions Required Without Reciprocity

Every dollar of sanctions relief is tied to a specific, verifiable Iranian action. Relief does not flow on promises. It flows on certified performance. If Iran stops performing, the money stops flowing. The President can defend this as a deal where the United States holds all the leverage.

Domestic Politics

The President can say: "They moved first on the dangerous material. We responded with humanitarian relief. Every step they take, we match. Every step they stop, we stop. We kept our military options. We got inspectors inside their facilities. We did not pay ransom — we got verified results."

2.2 What Iran Gets

Immediate Economic Relief

\$250 million flows on Day 1 through a Swiss escrow account, unrestricted for medicine, food, medical equipment, and aviation safety. This is not a promise. It is a hard credit. Larger asset tranches follow in 15-day windows as the IAEA certifies compliance. By Day 90, Iran could see \$2-3 billion in released sovereign assets.

Formal US Recognition of Iran's Nuclear Rights

The United States publishes a formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV. This is not symbolic. It is a written, public commitment that changes the diplomatic framing of every future negotiation. Iran can cite this as a US admission that enrichment itself is not the issue.

Maritime Pressure Eases

US naval forces move to a stand-off posture — no patrols within 5 nautical miles of the Hormuz transit corridor. Iranian commercial shipping gains breathing room. The naval blockade that has crippled Iran's oil exports loosens. This is a visible, immediate sovereign win.

No Surrender of Sovereign Title

The transferred uranium goes to IAEA custody in Oman. It does not go to the United States. Iran retains sovereign title. Iranian observers accompany every stage of packaging and transit. A neutral state (Oman) holds the material. Iran can frame this as placing its material in international trust, not delivering it to an adversary.

Domestic Politics

The government can say: "We secured the release of our frozen assets. We ended the naval blockade. We obtained a formal US recognition of our nuclear rights under the NPT. We transferred material to IAEA trust, not to America. We preserved all our rights for the comprehensive negotiation. This was economic recovery through diplomatic strength, not capitulation."

Both narratives describe the same facts. Neither is false. Neither contradicts the framework text. This is the core design insight: a deal works only if both sides can defend it at home.

3. The Problem This Solves

As of 16 May 2026, the situation is dangerous and wasteful.

- A ceasefire brokered by Pakistan technically holds, but both sides are running out of patience.
- The United States demands that Iran dismantle enrichment facilities and surrender its HEU stockpile before receiving any relief. Iran demands that the United States lift sanctions and end the naval blockade before making any nuclear concessions.
- President Trump called Iran's latest counteroffer "TOTALLY UNACCEPTABLE." Iran's Foreign Ministry called US demands a violation of its sovereign rights.
- Brent crude is near \$100 per barrel. US gasoline prices have risen 44% year-on-year. Iran's economy is under severe strain from dual blockades.
- Drone attacks in the Gulf are rattling the truce. Iran's parliament warned that "restraint is over."
- IAEA inspectors have not visited Iranian sites since the June 2025 strikes. The international community does not know the current status of approximately 440 kg of 60% enriched uranium.

The parties are not negotiating. They are making demands and waiting for the other to blink. This framework breaks that pattern by making both sides blink at the same time — in a structured, verified, reciprocal exchange that neither side can exploit.

4. Design Principles

Seven principles govern every provision in this framework:

- 1. Synchronised Reciprocal Motion.** Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian step is matched by a US step in the same 72-hour window. If one side stops, the other stops. This eliminates the "who moves first" trap that killed every previous negotiation.
- 2. Modular, Separable Tracks.** Nuclear stabilisation is a standalone module. Regional security (Hormuz, proxies, Lebanon) is a separate module that can be negotiated later. Progress on one track does not depend on progress on the other. The framework does not collapse because of a disagreement about Hezbollah or the Strait.
- 3. Nothing Is Permanent in Phase One.** The first phase lasts 90 days. It renews only by mutual consent. Either side can pause without triggering collapse. No centrifuge is destroyed. No facility is dismantled. No sanction is permanently lifted. Every step is reversible.
- 4. Front-Loaded Benefits.** Both sides receive a visible, quantifiable win on Day 1. This creates immediate political constituencies for the deal in both capitals. Neither leader has to wait months to point to a concrete result.
- 5. Domestic Defensibility.** Every concession is paired with a talking point. Every talking point is factually accurate. Neither leader has to lie to their parliament or their public to defend this deal.
- 6. Graduated Response, Not Automatic Collapse.** If something goes wrong, the framework does not self-destruct. It pauses. It reviews. It mediates. Only deliberate, verified, hostile violations trigger full rollback. Ambiguity triggers investigation, not punishment.
- 7. Separation of Technical from Political.** A verification dispute does not become a diplomatic crisis. A political disagreement (about Hormuz, about proxies, about rhetoric) does not trigger nuclear rollback. The channels are structurally separated.

5. The Core Reciprocal Exchange

The heart of the framework is a simultaneous exchange that activates within 72 hours of both parties signing a short letter of intent. Both sides activate together. There is no sequence. There is no "after you."

5.1 What Iran Gives (and What It Does Not Give)

Table 1. Iran's Day-One Commitments

Iran Gives	What This Means in Practice	What Iran Does NOT Give
Places its entire 60% HEU stockpile under IAEA seal at Esfahan for verified transfer to Oman	IAEA inspectors seal the cylinders on Day 1. A convoy departs under IAEA guard within 14 days. Iranian observers travel with every shipment.	Iran does NOT transfer material directly to the United States. It does NOT surrender sovereign title. It does NOT dismantle any facility.
Halts all enrichment above 3.67% U-235 effective immediately	IAEA inspectors confirm within 72 hours that no cascade is enriching above 3.67%. Continuous monitoring verifies this daily.	Iran does NOT dismantle any centrifuge. It does NOT close any facility. It retains all enrichment infrastructure at 3.67%.
Commits to installing no new centrifuges for 90 days	No new IR-1, IR-2, IR-4, or IR-6 machines are installed at any facility during the first phase.	This is a 90-day freeze, not a permanent ban. Renewal requires mutual consent.
Opens declared storage sites to IAEA inspectors on Day 1	IAEA teams receive immediate access to confirm the stockpile inventory and apply seals. Iranian escorts accompany all inspections.	Access is limited to declared sites under standard IAEA Additional Protocol authority. Military sites are addressed separately if needed.

5.2 What the United States Gives (and What It Does Not Give)

Table 2. US Day-One Commitments

The United States Gives	What This Means in Practice	What the US Does NOT Give
Releases \$250 million via Swiss escrow to Iran's Central Bank humanitarian account	Money is available for medicine, food, medical equipment, and aviation safety within 72 hours. The escrow agent confirms the transfer.	This is not a return of all frozen assets. It is a targeted, humanitarian-only tranche. Broader asset releases require verified Iranian compliance.
Transitions naval forces to stand-off posture (no patrols within 5 nm of Hormuz corridor)	US Navy vessels pull back from close-proximity interdiction. Commercial transit through Hormuz becomes safer. Omani monitors verify the posture.	The United States does NOT withdraw its fleet from the Gulf. It does NOT lift all sanctions. It does NOT end secondary sanctions on third countries.
Issues an OFAC general license for humanitarian trade for 90 days	Banks can process transactions for medicine, food, and medical equipment without fear of US penalties for 90 days.	This license is humanitarian-only. Oil sales, financial transactions, and military trade remain restricted.
Publishes a formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV	Both capitals publish the same text simultaneously. This is a written, public commitment.	This does NOT endorse enrichment to any specific level. It does NOT override existing sanctions. It is a statement of principle.
Commits to no new sanctions designations for framework duration	No new individuals, entities, or sectors are added to US sanctions lists during the 90-day phase.	Existing sanctions remain fully in force. The United States can reimpose paused sanctions at any time if Iran materially breaches.

5.3 What Neither Side Is Asked to Give

Off the Table in Phase One

- US recognition of any specific Iranian right to enrich above 3.67%
- Iranian dismantlement of any centrifuge, facility, or infrastructure
- US withdrawal of military forces from the region
- Iranian cessation of support for any proxy group
- US return of all frozen Iranian assets
- Iranian transfer of HEU directly to US custody
- Any commitment regarding missiles, regional security, or diplomatic normalisation
- Any permanent, irreversible obligation by either side

These issues may be addressed in later phases if both sides agree. They are not preconditions for Phase One.

6. The First-Phase Offer: One Module, Not Six

Previous frameworks bundled nuclear, maritime, proxy, banking, economic, and diplomatic tracks into a single complex package. This framework does the opposite. **Phase One has one module: the nuclear custodial exchange paired with targeted economic relief.** Everything else is deferred to Phase Two or handled through separate diplomatic channels.

Why one module? Because complexity kills deals. Every additional track adds veto points. Every additional body adds bureaucratic friction. Every additional condition gives domestic opponents another target. A simple, reciprocal, verifiable exchange is easier to sell, easier to verify, and harder to sabotage.

The 90-day timeline uses flexible windows, not hard deadlines:

Table 3. Phase-One Timeline

Window	Iranian Action	US Action	Verifier
Days 1-3	HEU stockpile placed under IAEA seal; enrichment above 3.67% halts	\$250M humanitarian tranche released; naval stand-off begins	IAEA (nuclear); Swiss escrow (financial); Oman (maritime)
Days 4-14	IAEA completes inventory; convoy prepares for transit	OFAC humanitarian license active; no new sanctions	IAEA issues inventory certificate
Days 14-30	Convoy transits to Oman; HEU placed in custody facility	First sanctions tranche unlocks (petrochemicals, oil services)	IAEA confirms custody transfer; Oman confirms receipt
Days 30-60	Enrichment cap verified daily; no new centrifuges installed	Second asset tranche releases (\$500M)	IAEA 30-day compliance report
Days 60-90	Continued compliance; negotiations on Phase Two begin	Third asset tranche releases (\$500M); aviation parts license	IAEA 60-day compliance report

At Day 90, both sides decide: extend, deepen, or conclude. There is no automatic progression. Either side can walk away without penalty. If both sides agree to extend, Phase Two can add regional, banking, or diplomatic modules. But Phase Two cannot begin until Phase One is complete and both parties affirmatively agree.

7. Verification: Simplified

The verification architecture in previous frameworks was complex: multiple committees, overlapping jurisdictions, and too many triggers for escalation. This framework strips it down to three verifiers with clear, separate jobs.

7.1 Who Certifies What

Table 4. Verifier Responsibilities

What Needs Certifying	Who Certifies	How	Within What Window
HEU stockpile is sealed, accounted for, and in transit or custody	IAEA Director-General or designated senior inspector	Physical inventory + mass spectrometry + chain-of-custody documentation	14-21 days (flexible)
US naval forces have moved to stand-off posture	Designated Facilitating State (Oman)	AIS vessel tracking + independent maritime observer confirmation	3-7 days
Humanitarian funds have been credited to Iranian account	Swiss escrow agent	Banking confirmation of irrevocable transfer	1-3 days
Enrichment above 3.67% has halted and remains halted	IAEA	Daily sensor data + periodic physical inspection	Ongoing; formal report every 15 days
No new centrifuges installed	IAEA	Physical inspection of declared facilities	30-day confirmation report

There is no Joint Commission with voting procedures. There is no complex hierarchy of committees. Each verifier has one job, reports directly to both parties, and publishes findings to a shared digital dashboard that both sides can view in real time.

7.2 Ambiguity vs Breach: A Clear Line

This distinction is critical. Too many frameworks collapsed because a data anomaly was treated as a deliberate violation.

Ambiguity (Investigate, Do Not Punish)

- A sensor reads differently from the day before but other sensors agree
- A shipment is delayed by weather or customs
- Bank transfer documentation has a formatting error
- One IAEA inspector files a report that contradicts another

Response: 7-day investigation window. Both parties meet with the relevant verifier. No consequences trigger during investigation. The framework continues.

Breach (Verified, Deliberate, Material)

- Mass spectrometry confirms enrichment above 3.67% after Day 1
- New centrifuges are physically installed and verified by IAEA inspection
- HEU cylinders are unsealed without IAEA authorisation
- The United States imposes new sanctions after committing not to

Response: Tier 1: 14-day remediation window. Tier 2: Discretionary relief pauses. Tier 3 (only for deliberate hostile violations): Full rollback consideration. See Section 10.

7.3 Fallback If a Verifier Is Unavailable

Table 5. Verifier Fallback Chain

Primary Verifier	Fallback If Unavailable	Secondary Fallback
IAEA (nuclear verification)	Joint Swiss-Norwegian technical team	IAEA Deputy Director with independent inspection team from Brazil or Singapore
Oman (maritime observation)	Qatar (pre-agreed maritime monitoring)	UN Office for West Asia independent maritime monitor
Switzerland (financial confirmation)	Qatar National Bank escrow division	UN-backed independent financial auditor

If all verifiers in a chain are unavailable, the obligation in question enters a 21-day hold. No party is penalised for a verifier's unavailability. Both parties are expected to cooperate in finding a replacement.

8. Economic Relief: Incremental and Reversible

The economic architecture is designed so that each dollar of relief is tied to a specific verified action, and each tranche can be paused or reversed independently.

Table 6. Relief Tranches: Size, Trigger, and Reversibility

Tranche	Window	Amount	What Iran Must Do	Can US Pause?	Can US Reverse?
Humanitarian Pilot	Days 1-3	\$250M	Place HEU under IAEA seal; halt enrichment above 3.67%	No (this is the matched Day-One exchange)	No (matched exchange is irreversible on both sides)
Petrochemical Window	Days 14-30	Licences only (no cash)	Confirm transit to Oman; maintain enrichment cap	Yes, if IAEA reports non-compliance	Yes, licence revocation takes 72 hours
Asset Tranche A	Days 30-45	\$500M	30 days of verified compliance with enrichment cap	Yes, pending IAEA report	Yes, funds can be re-frozen within 72 hours
Asset Tranche B	Days 45-60	\$500M	45 days of verified compliance	Yes	Yes
Asset Tranche C	Days 60-75	\$500M	60 days of verified compliance	Yes	Yes
Asset Tranche D	Days 75-90	\$500M	75 days of verified compliance	Yes	Yes

Total potential Phase-One asset release: \$2.25 billion, released in increments of \$500M every 15 days, each contingent on the IAEA's certification that the enrichment cap holds and no new centrifuges are installed. If Iran breaches at any point, the next tranche does not release. Already-released tranches are not clawed back for minor or ambiguous incidents. They are only re-frozen if the IAEA certifies a material, deliberate breach.

Domestic Politics of Each Tranche

Humanitarian Pilot (\$250M): The President can say this is emergency humanitarian assistance, not a concession. Iran can say it is the first instalment of its own sovereign assets being returned.

Petrochemical Licences: The President can say this creates US jobs in the oil services sector. Iran can say it reopens a key export channel.

Asset Tranches (\$500M every 15 days): The President can say each payment was earned through verified performance. Iran can say the international community is restoring confidence in its economy.

9. The Regional Track: Separated

Regional issues — Hormuz governance, proxy activity, Lebanon, Yemen — are real and urgent. But they are structurally separated from the nuclear module in Phase One.

The separation works as follows:

- **Nuclear compliance does not depend on regional behaviour.** If a proxy group acts, or if Hormuz has an incident, the nuclear verification and asset release continue on their own track.
- **Regional issues are discussed in parallel channels.** The Omani-facilitated ceasefire hotline and the Geneva backchannel handle regional incidents. These channels are not part of the nuclear compliance architecture.
- **Phase Two can add a regional module if both sides agree.** But Phase One does not require regional agreement to proceed. Phase One does not require a Lebanon ceasefire. Phase One does not require proxy demobilisation.
- **The naval stand-off is the only regional element in Phase One.** It is included because it is the matched US step for Iran's HEU custody transfer. It is a concrete, verifiable military posture adjustment, not a regional diplomatic settlement.

This separation is not a dismissal of regional issues. It is a recognition that bundling everything together creates a package so complex that any single disagreement can kill the whole deal. The nuclear track is urgent and time-bound. The regional track is complex and long-term. They should move on separate timelines.

10. Rollback: Graduated, Not Automatic

Too many frameworks have "automatic" consequences that trigger collapse at the first sign of trouble. This framework replaces automation with graduated human judgment.

Table 7. Three-Tier Rollback System

Tier	Trigger	Response	What Survives
Tier 1: Technical Fix	Single data anomaly; one missed reporting deadline by less than 48 hours; minor equipment issue	14-day remediation. Enhanced monitoring of the specific item. No relief suspension.	All asset releases. All licences. All channels.
Tier 2: Discretionary Pause	IAEA confirms enrichment above 3.67%; unauthorised centrifuge installation; UF6 diversion to undeclared location	Next asset tranche is held. Petrochemical licences reviewed. 60-day remediation window opens.	Humanitarian channel. Enrichment cap (monitored, not rewarded). Ceasefire hotline.
Tier 3: Full Review	Weaponisation activity confirmed by IAEA plus two independent technical sources; sustained non-compliance after Tier 2 expires	All pending asset releases frozen. Pre-Framework sanctions posture resumes. Reconstitution conference convened within 30 days.	Humanitarian corridor under UN mandate. IAEA baseline monitoring. Ceasefire hotline active for 180 days. Custodial stockpile remains in IAEA hands.

Key design features:

- **Only deliberate, verified, hostile violations reach Tier 3.** Ambiguity, technical glitches, and administrative delays are Tier 1.
- **Humanitarian channels survive all tiers.** Medicine, food, and medical equipment flows continue regardless of breach status.
- **Already-released funds are not clawed back for Tier 1 or Tier 2.** Only Tier 3 triggers re-freezing, and even then, the earliest-released humanitarian tranche is protected.
- **No military authorisation is embedded in any tier.** Breach does not equal war. It equals structured review and diplomatic re-engagement.

10.1 Mediation Before Escalation

Before any response beyond Tier 1, the following mediation sequence is mandatory:

1. **Technical Consultation (Days 1-3):** Both parties meet with the relevant verifier to review the data. The goal is clarification, not accusation.
2. **Facilitator Engagement (Days 4-7):** If the technical consultation does not resolve the issue, the Designated Facilitating State (Oman) convenes a confidential mediation session. Both parties attend. The facilitator issues a non-binding assessment.
3. **Joint Review (Days 8-14):** If mediation fails, both parties submit written positions to the IAEA Director-General, who issues a technical determination. This determination is advisory, not binding.
4. **Escalation (Day 15+):** Only if all three mediation steps fail does Tier 2 or Tier 3 activate. At this point, the decision to escalate is taken by each party's senior leadership, not by an automatic mechanism.

This 14-day mediation window applies to all incidents except a confirmed, verified armed attack by one party on the other. Self-defence is not restricted. But retaliation must still follow the mediation sequence unless the attack is ongoing.

11. Institutional Structure: Small

Previous frameworks created elaborate institutional architectures: Joint Commissions, subcommittees, working groups, media panels, and review bodies. This framework creates three bodies. That is all.

Table 8. Institutional Structure

Body	Location	What It Does	Staff
Shared Dashboard	Hosted by Switzerland; mirrored in Oman	Publishes real-time data on verification, compliance, asset transfers, and naval posture. Both parties have equal access. Data is filtered to protect industrial and military secrets.	Neutral IT team (4 people)
Crisis Hotline	Muscat, Oman	24/7 phone line between senior US and Iranian officials, staffed by Omani diplomats. Handles urgent incidents, technical questions, and mediation requests. Not a negotiating forum.	Omani duty officers (3 per shift)
Facilitator's Office	Geneva, Switzerland (primary); Muscat, Oman (maritime backup)	Hosts verification data, manages escrow, convenes mediation sessions, publishes compliance reports. The facilitator does not judge compliance — the IAEA does. The facilitator manages process.	Neutral diplomatic staff (6 people)

There is no voting body. There is no weighted majority. There is no permanent secretariat with a mandate to interpret the framework. The IAEA judges nuclear compliance. The escrow agent judges financial transfers. Oman judges maritime posture. Each has its own domain. None can override the others.

The facilitator rotates annually between Oman and Switzerland. Either party can request a change of facilitator if it believes the current one has lost neutrality. The request triggers a 14-day consultation, after which the facilitator changes by mutual consent or, if no consent is reached, by IAEA Director-General appointment.

12. Implementation Matrix: Who, What, When

Table 9. Complete Phase-One Implementation Matrix

When	Iran Does	US Does	Verified By	If Not Done
Days 1-3	HEU sealed by IAEA; enrichment above 3.67% halted; inspectors given access	\$250M released via Swiss escrow; naval stand-off begins; OFAC humanitarian licence issued	IAEA (seal + inventory); Swiss escrow (transfer); Oman (naval AIS)	Either side can abort within 72 hours without penalty
Days 4-14	Prepares convoy; Iranian observers deployed	Maintains naval stand-off; no new sanctions	IAEA (convoy readiness); Oman (naval posture)	14-day extension available if logistical delays
Days 14-21	Convoy transits to Oman; HEU placed in custody	First sanctions licences unlock (petrochemicals, oil services)	IAEA (chain of custody); Oman (receipt confirmation)	7-day investigation window if transit delayed
Days 30-45	Maintains enrichment cap; no new centrifuges	Asset Tranche A releases (\$500M)	IAEA 30-day compliance report	Tranche held pending IAEA clarification
Days 45-60	Maintains enrichment cap; no new centrifuges	Asset Tranche B releases (\$500M)	IAEA 45-day compliance report	Tranche held; mediation window opens
Days 60-75	Maintains enrichment cap; no new centrifuges	Asset Tranche C releases (\$500M); aviation parts licence	IAEA 60-day compliance report	Tranche held; both sides review extension
Days 75-90	Maintains enrichment cap; no new centrifuges	Asset Tranche D releases (\$500M)	IAEA 75-day compliance report	Tranche held; decision point for Phase Two
Day 90	Decision point: Both sides decide to extend, deepen, or conclude. No automatic progression.		Joint statement required	If no agreement, Phase One obligations expire; stockpile remains in IAEA custody pending further negotiation

Annex A: Minimum Viable Agreement Options

If the full Phase-One package proves too complex or politically difficult, three smaller options are available. Each preserves the core principle: synchronised, reciprocal, verifiable exchange. Each is smaller and easier to defend.

Option 1: The Emergency Humanitarian Exchange

The smallest thing that could work

- **Iran gives:** 72-hour IAEA access to declared HEU storage sites for inventory and sealing. No transfer. No enrichment halt beyond a 72-hour observation window.
- **US gives:** \$250 million humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow. 30-day OFAC humanitarian licence. No naval adjustment.
- **Duration:** 30 days, renewable once.
- **Verifier:** IAEA only.
- **Why it works:** Iran gets immediate economic relief with minimal nuclear exposure. The US gets IAEA eyes on the stockpile with minimal concessions. Both sides test whether reciprocal motion is possible without major political exposure.

Option 2: The Custody-Only Exchange

Medium exposure, medium reward

- **Iran gives:** Full HEU stockpile transferred to IAEA custody in Oman. Enrichment capped at 3.67% for 90 days. No facility closures, no dismantlement.
- **US gives:** \$250 million humanitarian tranche. Naval stand-off within 5 nm of Hormuz. No new sanctions for 90 days.
- **Duration:** 90 days, no asset tranches beyond the initial \$250M.
- **Verifier:** IAEA + Oman.
- **Why it works:** This is the full nuclear stabilisation without the complex economic architecture. Iran gets the security and maritime wins. The US gets the HEU out and the cap in place. The economic negotiations happen separately, through existing diplomatic channels, without being bundled into the nuclear compliance framework.

Option 3: The Full Phase One (as described in this document)

Maximum confidence-building

- All elements of Option 2, plus four incremental asset tranches (\$500M each) tied to 15-day compliance reports.
- Petrochemical and aviation licences.
- Full verification dashboard and crisis hotline.
- 90 days, with decision point for extension or Phase Two.

How to Choose

Either party can propose starting with Option 1 or 2 and graduating to Option 3 if the initial exchange works. There is no penalty for starting small. The framework is designed to reward success with expanded cooperation, not to demand maximum commitment upfront.

The graduated path works as follows: if Option 1 succeeds (30 days, IAEA access confirmed, humanitarian tranche delivered), both sides can agree by exchange of letters to activate Option 2. If Option 2 succeeds (90 days, HEU in custody, enrichment cap verified), both sides can agree to activate Option 3. Each graduation requires only a short exchange of letters, not a new negotiation.

Annex B: Sources

This framework synthesises technical and diplomatic innovations from six independent working documents and current reporting as of 16 May 2026.

Table 10. Reference Documents

Document	Version	Key Contributions to This Framework
Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework	v6.0 (May 2026)	Day-One exchange design; 14-Day Stabilization Gate; three-tier rollback; Mutual Non-Humiliation Clause
Stability First Enhanced Accord	v5.7 (May 2026)	Micro-Pilot concept; distributed facilitating state matrix; Political Shock Absorber; Partial Continuity Rule
Stability First Phase II Nuclear Annex	v1.2 (May 2026)	Six Modular Pathways for HEU disposition; 12-year moratorium with Automatic Extension; Fordow IMIRC conversion
Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture	v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition	Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine; Non-Humiliation Doctrine; modular ratification architecture; Track Maturity Bands
The Crescent Compact	v1.6 Full-Spectrum (April 2026)	Crescent Cycle mechanics; Weighted Breach Index; Progressive Arches; Ambassador's Override; Constructive Ambiguity Doctrine
Comprehensive Regional Stability Framework	v4.3 (April 2026)	15-day synchronised cycles; VIU Protocol; Election Shock Absorbers; Minimal Compliance Mode; out-of-band verification

Current Events References:

- The Hill, "Iran lists demands rejected by Donald Trump," 12 May 2026
- Digital Journal / AFP, "No end to deadlock as Iran, US reject talks terms," 12 May 2026
- CryptoBriefing, "Iran's uranium stance threatens US nuclear deal prospects by May 31," 11 May 2026
- Wikipedia, "2025-2026 Iran-United States negotiations," accessed 15 May 2026
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